



GIANT BUGS



ou can hardly walk ten steps into the wilds without seeing a bug. Even worse, they can get **MUCH** bigger too, and deadly, did I mention they can still swarm? Beware if you venture in dense forests, wide wetlands or damp caves, because the bugs **ALWAYS** have numbers on their side. There are two main categories of dangerously large bugs: Swarming Bugs and Mighty Bugs. Giant swarm bugs have adapted to act in groups resembling loosely connected wolf packs.

When a swarming bug is distressed, they signal their swarm to aid them. Mighty Bugs, on the other hand, thrive in nature thanks to their enhanced chitin durability and larger size. Exoskeletons in great sizes only yield to the most decisive blows.

“Hear that? Bugs, I hate bugs—at least they’re little...” – Gorp, about to have a **BAD** day.

GM Note. These bug groups are intentionally generic, pick a kind of bug that works for your table. A LOT of people **HATE** certain kinds of bugs (they may be okay with beetles or ants, but the thought of giant roaches or spiders would be thoroughly unfun). Use your best judgment, some people like being scared or grossed out—others not so much!

SWARMING BUGS



Swarming Pheromones. At the end of each round: non-minion bugs summon a Bug Minion.

BUG MINION SMALL

Bite. 1d4. On hit: deal 2 damage instead.

Wherever there is A bug—there are MORE BUGS nearby.

Focus fire on heroes with high armor or near heroes with strong AoE abilities.

Multiple small creatures can fit in a single space. Surrounding a hero 10–20 minions can get deadly FAST (especially if they have low armor or no AoE abilities)!

GIANT BUG LVL 1/3, SMALL

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Bite. 1d4.

Many giant bug species are able to eat anything and live anywhere—infesting caves, wildernesses, and even urban environs.

Stay in melee reach or clump together with other bugs.

Move out of melee reach after attacking; summon minions in places that block movement and obstruct heroes' plans.

TOUGHRIDER BUG LVL 1, SMALL

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Strong Jaws. 1d4+4. On hit: Riding.

They possess a tough chitin coat and powerful jaws able to grip anything to the death, can fell entire forests if left unchecked.

Focus fire on heroes with high armor or near heroes with strong AoE abilities.

When Riding, attacks that miss you damage the Ridden target! Medium armor means these combo well with the Bonfire Bug's Eruption damage, taking no damage from it.

ACIDSHOT BUG LVL 2, SMALL

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Acid Splash: Melee attackers take 2 damage.

Acid Shot. (Range 6) 1d4+4.

They possess caustic sacs of acid and the deft skill to fire them at long range. They also ooze it at anyone who ventures too close.

Move adjacent to heroes and attack with disadvantage.

Stay at range (e.g., trees, ceiling of a tunnel) shoot, then move further away.

TPK ALTERNATIVES

Some bugs may try to capture the heroes to feed them to their larvae. Others may flee hearing the sound of a larger predator or very bright lights. For Bonfire Bugs, heroes may just barely survive explosions with ringing ears.

JACKER BUG LVL 2, SMALL

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Jacker Toxin. 1d4+4. On damage: Hijacked: (1/round) when able, you must Interpose for your Hijacker for free (healing ends).

When stung, every drop of blood in your body bends towards protecting your toxic captor until you die.

Attack first, allowing heroes to easily Defend. Foreshadow the effects of the Toxin (via an NPC or Naturecraft checks).

Attack with them last, after a hero has already Defended or attack in pairs to get damage through.

BONFIRE BUG LVL 3, SMALL

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Sizzle. 1d4+4.

Skittering Eruption: Move 3 then deal 1d20 damage to ALL adjacent creatures.

DO NOT APPROACH. Many have been either injured or killed by these infernal insects. Molting season makes them AGGRESSIVE.

Allow a hero who kills one to knock it in a direction where it will explode and take out other bugs.

Skitter toward heroes who are clumped closely together, or start a chain reaction with other bonfire bugs!

HIVEDRIVER BUG LVL 4, LARGE

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Distress Call. When attacked, summon a Bug Minion.

- **Swarm.** Summon a Bug Minion. Then:
- **Bite.** 1d4+4. On crit: summon a Bug Minion.

These bugs live long enough to grow to the size of a coach and become a living hive. KILL ON SIGHT.

BUG LOOT

- **Pheromone Sac.** (Single use) Action: control all Bug Minions within Reach 2 for 1 round.
- **Bonfire Bug Organ.** Action: throw up to 2+STR spaces. 1d20 damage to all adjacent spaces where it impacts.
- **Iridescent Bug Wings.** Beautiful. Valuable to clothiers, nobility, as well as less-civilized creatures.
- **Hooked Articulating Leg.** Can use it to grab small objects within Reach 2.
- **Bug Larva.** (1d4 portions) Consume (if you can stomach it) during a Rest to regain 1 HD.
- **Jacker Toxin.** When ingested/injected a creature will see you as an ally for a brief time.